CORE FALSE BELIEF #13 · OTHER PEOPLE

“My needs don’t matter.”

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Where it often comes from

Many people learn this in families where their needs were ignored, mocked, or treated as selfish, or where they had to take care of a parent or siblings. Some were praised for always putting others first, so they learned that having needs was bad. As adults they may say yes to everything, neglect rest and health, and feel resentful or exhausted without knowing why.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture shows a God who cares about our needs. He opens His hand and satisfies the desires of every living thing, and He promises to supply all our needs in Christ. When Elijah was exhausted and despairing, God gave him food and sleep before anything else. Jesus said to love your neighbor as yourself, which assumes that caring for yourself is normal. Serving others is good, but God never asks you to pretend you have no needs. Your needs matter to Him.

> *“And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus”* (Philippians 4:19).

Also see

> “The eyes of all look to You, and You give them their food in season. You open Your hand and satisfy the desire of every living thing” (Psalm 145:15–16).

> “Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, ‘Get up and eat.’ And he looked around, and there by his head was a cake of bread baked over hot coals, and a jar of water. So he ate and drank and lay down again. A second time the angel of the LORD returned and touched him, saying, ‘Get up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you.’” (1 Kings 19:5–7).

> “The second is this: ‘Love your neighbor as yourself.’ No other commandment is greater than these” (Mark 12:31).

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light” (Matthew 11:28–30).

Common self-statements

- Other people’s needs come first, always.
- It’s selfish to want anything for myself.
- I don’t want to be a bother.
- I can rest when everything else is done.
- If I say no, people will be upset.
- My feelings aren’t important.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either meet every need of others or be selfish.
- Should statements: Telling myself I should never need anything.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring the times my needs were met and it was good.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will be upset if I express a need.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that my needs don't matter?
- What needs am I ignoring right now?
- Is caring for myself really selfish?
- How did God care for Elijah when he was exhausted?
- What happens to me when I ignore my needs for too long?
- What is one need I could honestly express this week?

Truth summary

> I care about others, and that is good. But my needs matter too, to God and to the people who love me. God supplies my needs and cares about my body, rest, and feelings. I can take care of myself and still serve others.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Help
- Self-Sacrifice
- Tired
- Love, General

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My needs don't matter"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My needs don't matter." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn my needs don't matter?
- ☐ What needs am I ignoring?
- ☐ Is caring for myself selfish?
- ☐ How did God care for Elijah?
- ☐ What happens when I ignore my needs?
- ☐ What need can I express this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will supply all my needs.
- ☐ My needs matter to God.
- ☐ Rest and care are not selfish.
- ☐ I can love others as I love myself.
- ☐ Saying no can be healthy.
- ☐ Jesus offers me rest.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Philippians 4:19**
  "And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **1 Kings 19:5–7**
  "Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, 'Get up and eat.' And he looked around, and there by his head was a cake of bread baked over hot coals, and a jar of water. So he ate and drank and lay down again. A second time the angel of the LORD returned and touched him, saying, 'Get up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you.'"
- ☐ **Mark 12:31**
  "The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' No other commandment is greater than these."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A need I met: Each day, write one need you noticed in yourself and what you did about it.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Philippians 4:19 becomes: "Maria can write: "God will supply what I need. My needs matter to Him, and I can take care of them.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Name your needs. Write a list of what you need: rest, food, friendship, quiet, help. Circle one to address this week.
- ☐ Say one honest no. Decline one request this week that you would normally accept out of guilt. Notice what happens.
- ☐ Schedule rest. Put one hour of rest or enjoyment on your calendar and keep it like an appointment.
- ☐ Express a need. Tell one trusted person about a need you have, and let them help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My needs don't matter": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A need I took care of
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My needs don't matter.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have treated my needs as unimportant for so long. Thank You that You care about all of me and promise to supply what I need. Teach me to rest, to speak up, and to receive care without guilt. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.